Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

D and C

What is a D&C and for what purposes is it performed?	A dilatation and curettage (D&C) is a surgical procedure in which the endometrial lining of the uterus and any lesions, such as polyps or myomas, are removed. It is performed to complete a missed or incomplete spontaneous abortion, as a treatment of cervical stenosis, to diagnose and treat bleeding caused by cervical and uterine lesions, and as a method for pregnancy termination to a lesser extent. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 802.*
What are the common preoperative diagnoses seen in patients presenting for D&C.	Abnormal uterine bleeding; cervical stenosis; pregnancy termination; missed, incomplete, or induced abortion; or uncontrolled uterine bleeding (this is seen in young women in which hormone therapy has proven ineffective). *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 802.*
How is a patient positioned for a D&C?	Dorsal lithotomy position *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 802.*
What two medications can be used during a D&C to help manage blood loss?	Methylergonovine maleate and oxytocin *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 804.*
How is methylergonovine maleate administered? What is the dose?	Methylergonovine maleate is administered as an IM injection of 0.2 mg. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 804.*
List possible causes of severe postoperative bleeding following a D&C.	Cervical injury, uterine atony, uterine perforation, and retained product of conception (POC). *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 807.*
How does oxytocin aid in decreasing blood loss during a D&C?	By causing contraction of the uterus. *Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 806.*

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Upon dilatation of the cervix, a patient experiences bradycardia and hypotension. What accounts for this response? What is the treatment?

The patient is experiencing a vasovagal response. This is treated by immediate cessation of the stimulation (grasping and dilatation of the cervix), and atropine 0.4mg IV or glycopyrrolate 0.1-0.2 mg IV if so warranted.

Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 807.

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